

Participant Information Sheet (PIS)
Postgraduate Institute of Medical Education and Research, Chandigarh

Protocol no: version 0.3 (16th December 2024)

Sponsor: ICMR

Principal Investigator: Dr. Venkateseshan Sundaram

Name of the participant:

Title: Initial oxygen for delivery room resuscitation of preterm neonates: a triple-arm, multi-site, randomized, controlled trial

Information to participant

You are invited to take part in this research study being conducted in PGIMER, Chandigarh entitled: “Initial oxygen for delivery room resuscitation of preterm neonates: a triple-arm, multi-site, randomized, controlled trial” because your baby does satisfy our eligibility criteria of neonates admitted to the neonatal unit. The information in this document is meant to help you decide whether to take part in the study. Please feel free to ask if you have any queries or concerns.

What is the purpose of the study:

Premature neonates are at a higher risk of organ damage when given higher than required supplemental oxygen (hyperoxia). On the other hand, they face higher risk of death if they get lesser than required oxygen (hypoxia). Both the problems occur due to their immature defense mechanisms in the body. How much should be the appropriate concentration of supplemental oxygen for preterm neonates who require resuscitation when they are born in the delivery room is not known from the scientific literature. Knowing this is very important to provide the right amount of oxygen and to titrate the supplemented oxygen up or down based on the pulse saturations. This study will investigate by comparing two different beginning oxygen concentrations (60% or 90%) with 30% as standard in premature neonates who require resuscitation at birth and shall follow them to study various clinical outcomes till 44 weeks of post-menstrual age (which is calculated by adding their gestation at birth in weeks with the number of weeks they have lived postnatally).

What is the expected study duration?

The duration of the study is three years.

What is the study process and what are the procedures followed in this study?

Once you give consent to include your baby in this trial, your baby will be assessed at birth whether he/she needs resuscitation. This assessment will be done as per the most recent guidelines provided by the International Neonatal Resuscitation Program guidelines. If the assessment shows that your baby needs assistance at birth in the form of positive pressure ventilation using a T-piece resuscitator device, immediately he/she will be assigned to one of the three initial oxygen concentrations (30% or 60% or 90%). Following this, the administered oxygen concentration will be titrated up or down to target the oxygen saturations in the right upper limb based on the published saturations targets for the postnatal age. He/she will be receiving standard neonatal care after the initial oxygen. Your baby will be followed up till 44 weeks of post-menstrual age (till 1 month of age from the time of birth of a normal full-term baby) for various outcomes / problems related to lungs, eyes, intestines and brain during this

period. The details after birth of your baby will be recorded in paper forms and later transferred to computer forms. These details will include gestational age, birth weight, vital signs, major illnesses, etc. A project officer will brief you in detail about the collected data. All data collection will follow the data anonymity policy and shall abide by the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act of 1996 (HIPAA) regulations. For the sake of this trial, we would be requiring a total of 700 neonates (including your baby) as study participants over the duration of three years. The trial enrolment will happen from six large hospitals from all over the country.

What are the possible benefits to your child?

By consenting for the participation of your baby in this trial, you will help us to clearly understand and get an answer to the question of identifying the correct initial oxygen concentration. This will further the policy changes both nationally and globally. By getting the right oxygen concentration, your baby also potentially may benefit by being in this trial. You will not be paid any money or physical gift to participate in the study. Baby and mother will continue to receive standard clinical care irrespective of participation in the study.

What are the possible risks and discomforts to your child?

We do not foresee any direct adverse effect associated with the intervention as providing oxygen up to 30% for resuscitation of preterm neonates is the current standard of care. Receiving 60% or 90% initial oxygen for resuscitation may be associated with more release of free oxygen radicals. But the scientific evidence to support that these higher concentrations lead to serious problems in preterm neonates in the long term is absent. Your delivery will be attended by senior residents qualified and trained to provide resuscitation. Most of the clinical information will be collected non-invasively and no blood collection is required for the purpose of this trial. Therefore, no extra prick of the baby will be required. All medical records will be treated with the utmost confidentiality and will be revealed only to other doctors involved in the study. The results of this study would be published in a scientific journal/thesis, but you or your child will not be identified by name. A subset of 25% of randomly chosen babies will undergo MRI brain between 40 and 44 weeks post-menstrual age. The selection of babies for this investigation will be done randomly. MRI brain is a relatively safe investigation and without any ionizing radiation.

What are the alternatives available to you?

This study will compare 60% or 90% with the existing standard of 30% as initial oxygen concentration. The latter will be the alternative treatment available. You will be given full liberty to leave the study at any point in time if you wish and this decision will not have any effect on the management of the child.

Confidentiality of the data and records/information obtained from you:

All the data will be kept confidential. Personnel analyzing the data will have access to the anonymized data alone. Only the study investigators will have access to the data.

What will be the treatment schedule?

Standard treatment protocols and policies of the department will be followed.

What compensation and/or treatment(s) are available to the Participant in the event of a trial-related injury?

Neonates enrolled in the study, irrespective of the group assignment, will receive standard steps of neonatal resuscitation. Therefore, no trial-related injury is expected. As the trial is enrolling neonates requiring resuscitation, it is expected that some of the enrolled neonates will develop serious adverse events (SAE) including organ dysfunction (e.g. acute renal failure, hypoxic-ischemic encephalopathy, intestinal ischemia, brain hemorrhage, etc.) and death due to asphyxia. All the SAEs will be reported to the IEC and to a central DSMB. If SAEs are deemed to be caused due to study intervention (research related injury), participants will be entitled to financial compensation as per prescribed rules of the Government of India. Given that this is a clinical trial, we have sought funds for trial insurance from the sponsor (ICMR)

Whom to contact for trial related queries and what are the rights of Participants in the event of any injury?

In case of trial related queries, you must contact the undersigned principal investigator and co-investigators and the IEC (address given below)

Are the participants paid to take part in this study?

Participants are not paid for taking part in this study. Similarly, there will be no study related additional costs for the participants. However, in case if your child must be followed up for the sake of the study, the expenses related to the follow-up will be paid by the investigators.

What are your responsibilities during participation in the study?

You are requested to give correct responses to the questions and queries raised, if any. Your participation is voluntary, so that you may withdraw from the study anytime and the refusal to participate will not involve any penalty or loss of benefits. You or your representative will be informed in a timely manner if significant findings develop during the research.

Confidentiality of the information obtained from you:

All your personal information shall be kept confidential. By signing this document, you will be allowing the research team investigators, other study personnel, institutional ethics committee and any other person or agency required by law to view your data if required. The information from this study, if published in medical journals or presented at scientific meetings, will not reveal your identity. In case of any study related queries, you can feel free to ask any question from Dr. Venkateshan Sundaram, Principal Investigator of this study.

I, Dr. Venkateshan Sundaram, through the co-investigators and data collectors, shall be explaining the study to the participants, getting their consent, and addressing their study-related queries. The participants will be notified in a timely manner if any significant changes occur during the study which may affect the participant's willingness to continue in this study.

Contact persons:

Principal Investigator:

Dr. Venkateshan Sundaram
Professor, Division of Neonatology,
Department of Pediatrics, PGIMER, Chandigarh
Mob: 9478001129
Email: venkatpgi@gmail.com

Co-Investigators:

1. Dr Praveen Kumar, Professor, Division of Neonatology, Department of Pediatrics, PGIMER, Chandigarh.
2. Dr Jogender Kumar, Associate Professor, Division of Neonatology, Department of Pediatrics, PGIMER, Chandigarh.
3. Dr Kushaljit Singh Sodhi, Professor, Department of Radiodiagnosis and Imaging, PGIMER, Chandigarh.
4. Dr Sameer Vyas, Professor, Department of Radiodiagnosis and Imaging, PGIMER, Chandigarh.
5. Dr Vanita Jain, Professor, Department of Obstetrics and Gynecology, PGIMER, Chandigarh

In case of any conflicts, you can contact the chairperson or convener of our institutional ethics committee at the following address.

Convener Institutional Ethics Committee:

Dr. Ashish Kakkar,
Room No 6006, 6th floor,
Research Block B, PGIMER, Chandigarh,
Contact: 0172-2755266

Informed Consent Form (ICF)

Study Title: Initial oxygen for delivery room resuscitation of preterm neonates: a triple-arm, multi-site, randomized, controlled trial

Name of the site principal investigator: Dr Venkateshan Sundaram (9478001129)

Names of site co-PIs: Dr Praveen Kumar, Dr Jogender Kumar, Dr Kushaljit Singh Sodhi, Dr Sameer Vyas, Dr Vanita Jain

Participant's Initials: _____

Participant's Name: _____

Age: _____

Information	Participant's initial
1. I confirm that I have (been) read and understood the information sheet dated _____ for the above study and have had the opportunity to ask question	
2. I understand that my and my child's participation in the study is voluntary and that I am free to withdraw at any time, without giving any reason, without my medical care or legal rights being affected	
3. I agree not to restrict the use of any data or results that arise from this study provided such a use is only for scientific purpose(s)	
4. I agree for my child's participation in the above study	

Signature (or Thumb impression) of the Subject/Legally Acceptable Representative:

Date: ____/____/____

Signatory's Name: _____

Signature of the Investigator: _____

Date: ____/____/____

Study Investigator's Name: _____

1) Witness-1
Signature

Name and address:

2) Witness -2
Signature

Name and address: